

Nokia to Sell Vertu

According to the Financial Times, the Finnish mobile giant is looking to sell its luxury phone spinoff - Vertu - in 2012. <http://bit.ly/tXxD4U>

Tell Me Like Siri

Microsoft says it has had Siri-like tech for more than a year, since it launched its voice-recognition app, TellMe in 2009. <http://bit.ly/vah4Lj>

Scientists achieve 186Gbps transfer rate across standard fiber optic line

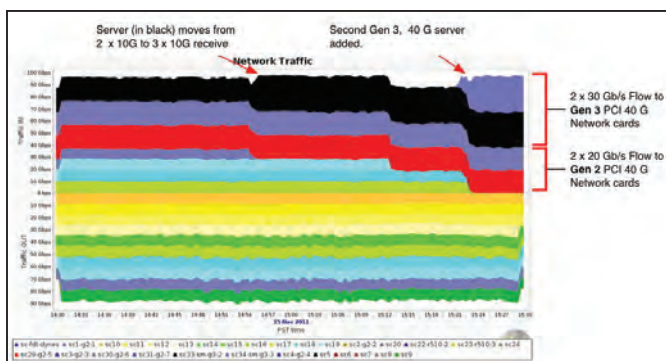
Heralding a practical new way to transfer data at unprecedented speeds, scientists from Caltech and the University of Victoria have achieved a sustained data transfer rate between computers of 186 Gbps, across a standard, commercially available fibre optic line.

The team of researchers consisted of scientists from various fields, including high-energy physics, computer science, and engineering. The 186 Gbps transfer rate (98 Gbps in one direction, 88 Gbps in the other) was achieved over a 100 Gbps bidirectional fibre optic line that stretched 217 km

from the SuperComputing 2011 (SC11) convention in Seattle, to the University of Victoria Computer Centre in Canada.

The Caltech team at SC11 used 13 servers and 40 Gbps LAN connections, while University of Victoria team used 10 servers and 10 Gbps LAN connections to achieve the two computer-to-computer data transfer rate records.

The first record, the 186 Gbps data transfer rate (~23.25 GB/s) was achieved in a memory-to-memory transfer, while the second, 60 Gbps (~7.5GB/s) was achieved in a disk-to-disk transfer. Real world applications for such speeds already exist, with many scientific projects across the world needing to share petabytes of data with other institutions. **d**



Microsoft India launches software tools for disabled persons

Microsoft India has launched a set of 40 templates for most commonly used software to help visually, hearing and learning impaired people. These templates

automatically create accessible documents for the disabled people. With an objective to increase the job prospects through skill development, the software major has also launched 'Microsoft Office

Specialist Certification' programme for impaired persons.

These tools have been specially created for the software used for public distribution circulars, forms, gazettes and notifications. The Microsoft tools will also help create accessible templates for such documents as laws, policies, officer orders/notifications, census data and others. **d**

Beetel launches Magiq Glide, an Android 2.2 tablet priced at ₹11,999

Beetel Teletech has launched a new tablet called "Magiq Glide". The new Beetel tablet runs on Android 2.2 Froyo operating system and has been given an MRP of ₹11,999. Beetel had previously launched Magiq and Magiq II tablets.

The new Magiq Glide tablet comes with SIM calling feature. It also features a 7.0-inch WVGA screen, 2MP front facing and a rear camera. As



for storage, it has 8GB internal memory, which is expandable up to 16 GB. The device comes with a 2,200 mAh battery and supports Wi-Fi and 3G. The Magiq Glide is powered by a 1GHz processor for faster processing speed. The tablet also features access to the Android Market. **d**

Samsung buys out Sony's stake in S-LCD joint-venture

Samsung is buying out Sony's stake in their LCD joint-venture, S-LCD Corporation, formed back in 2004. The venture hasn't been working very well for Sony, which has

reportedly been making a loss in the market for the past seven years. Sony had to contend with a weakening Japanese currency, and lowered profit margins in the face of falling prices since 2008. Samsung on the other

hand, has grown to become the largest manufacturer of LCD and flat screen televisions in the world.

The Korean giant is reportedly buying Sony's stake for paltry sum of roughly \$939m.

Sony will still procure its LCD panels from Samsung, at market prices, Samsung on the other hand, will gain "heightened flexibility, speed and efficiency in both panel production and business operations" with its full ownership. The LCD panel industry has seen a lot of scope in last couple of decades, used for more than just television sets, from cameras to computers, and mobile phones. **d**